SELF-COACHING ATHLETE

MASTER CURRICULUM

A structured beginner-to-advanced learning and training curriculum for strength, muscle, calisthenics, running, power, athletics, HYROX, boxing/fighting, mobility, conditioning and long-term physical development.

This edition is deliberately different from a reference guide: it is written as a curriculum. Each discipline has prerequisites, levels, weekly practice, progression rules, advancement tests, troubleshooting and advanced pathways.

PART	PURPOSE
A — Universal foundation	Safety, assessment, movement, training science, nutrition, recovery and programming
B — Strength & muscle	A complete resistance-training curriculum from first session to advanced programming
C — Calisthenics	Skill ladders, strength prerequisites, practice sessions and advancement standards
D — Running	Run/walk through aerobic base, threshold, intervals and performance training
E — Power & athletics	Landing, jumping, acceleration, sprinting, deceleration and change of direction
F — HYROX	Official race structure, station skills, compromised running and race preparation
G — Boxing & fighting	Technical curriculum, conditioning, partner work, sparring pathway and coaching boundaries
H — Integration	How to combine disciplines without destroying recovery
I — Long-term system	12-month roadmap, tests, logs, troubleshooting and specialization

Important boundary: this document can teach principles, progressions and practice structure. It cannot safely replace an in-person coach for advanced combat skills, sparring, high-risk plyometrics, maximal sprinting, complex Olympic lifting, or diagnosis/rehabilitation.

How to Use This Curriculum

The previous master guide was a reference manual. This version is the curriculum that should sit underneath it. A reader should not jump randomly between advanced exercises. They should enter at Level 0, pass prerequisites, progress through the levels, and only then use advanced material.

STEP	ACTION	OUTPUT
1	Read Part A	Know safety, training variables and how to assess yourself
2	Choose 1 primary + 1–2 secondary goals	Prevent conflicting priorities
3	Perform baseline tests	Create a measurable starting point
4	Enter the correct level	Never skip prerequisites because an exercise looks impressive
5	Train using the weekly template	Repeat the same structure long enough to adapt
6	Log every session	Create objective evidence of progression
7	Pass advancement criteria	Earn the next level
8	Deload/retest	Confirm adaptation before increasing complexity
9	Specialize	Shift volume toward the sport you want to master
10	Use coaching where skill/contact risk is high	Do not turn a PDF into a substitute for expert supervision

Rule of the curriculum: if you cannot demonstrate the prerequisite with good control, stay at the current level. Progression is earned by performance, not by calendar date.

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1. Safety, Medical Boundaries & Readiness

This curriculum is for generally healthy people. It is not a diagnosis or rehabilitation manual.

Before training

- Do not train through unexplained chest pain/pressure, fainting/near-fainting, severe or unusual breathlessness, acute neurological symptoms or serious injury.
- Persistent pain, repeated injuries or unexplained major performance decline warrant professional assessment.
- New trainees with significant medical conditions should obtain appropriate medical guidance before hard training.
- Combat sports, maximal sprinting, advanced plyometrics and complex lifting have higher technical demands; learn them with qualified supervision.

Combat-sport boundary

England Boxing's coaching framework treats technical skill, conditioning, movement skill, competition and the role of the coach as distinct parts of boxing development. Its current 2026 rules also contain medical/sparring requirements. A document can teach concepts; it cannot safely supervise contact, timing or opponent-specific decisions.
■cite■turn0search48■turn0search5■

Readiness rule

If a session causes symptoms beyond expected exertion, stop and reassess. Never use a progression table as permission to ignore warning signs.

2. Assessment & Baseline Testing

Baseline testing tells the reader where to enter the curriculum and gives objective evidence of change.

General baseline

TEST	HOW TO RECORD	WHY
Body mass	Same conditions, 1–3 readings/week	Trend, not daily emotion
Waist	Consistent site/conditions	Body-composition trend
Push-ups	Strict reps before technique breaks	Upper-body endurance
Chin-ups/pull-ups	Strict reps	Relative pulling strength
Dead hang	Controlled time	Grip/shoulder tolerance
Plank/hollow	Best clean hold	Trunk control
1 km	Controlled test when safe	Running performance
Broad jump	Best of 3 with safe landing	Power

Baseline procedure

- Warm up first
- Do not test every quality maximally on the same day if fatigue could affect results
- Record conditions, surface and footwear
- Retest under similar conditions

Entry-level decision

If you cannot perform a clean repetition, enter the assisted/regression level. If you can perform the movement easily with excellent control, start at the next appropriate level rather than repeating beginner work indefinitely.

3. Training Science: How Adaptation Works

Training works through repeated exposure to a manageable stimulus.

Core variables

VARIABLE	QUESTION	PROGRESSION EXAMPLE
Volume	How much?	3 sets → 4 sets
Intensity	How hard?	20 kg → 22.5 kg
Frequency	How often?	2 → 3 exposures
Specificity	How similar?	General pull → strict pull-up
Effort	How close to limit?	RIR 4 → RIR 2
Recovery	Can you adapt?	Add rest/reduce load

What the evidence says

The 2026 ACSM overview synthesized 137 systematic reviews involving more than 30,000 participants. It found resistance training improves strength, hypertrophy, power and multiple functional outcomes; heavier loads support strength, higher weekly volume supports hypertrophy, and moderate loads moved quickly support power. It also found that many elaborate prescription variables do not consistently dominate outcomes. ■cite■turn0search3■

The practical loop

Stimulus → fatigue → recovery → adaptation → progressive stimulus. The curriculum therefore uses simple progression first and advanced methods only when the basic methods stop being sufficient.

4. Exercise Technique & Warm-Ups

Technique is a skill. Learn the movement before increasing difficulty.

Universal warm-up

- General temperature raise
- Dynamic mobility relevant to the session
- Specific practice sets
- Progressive explosive work for speed/power days

Technique checklist

CHECK	PASS STANDARD
Position	Repeatable start and finish
Control	No uncontrolled collapse or swing
ROM	Appropriate, pain-free range
Breathing	Can brace/breathe without losing position
Fatigue	Technique remains acceptable

Video learning

Record occasional sets from useful angles. Compare with the written criteria, not with social-media aesthetics. For boxing and advanced calisthenics, coach feedback becomes increasingly valuable as complexity rises.

5. Programming, Progression & Deloads

Programming is the system that converts exercises into adaptation.

Progression methods

METHOD	USE WHEN	EXAMPLE
Double progression	Stable exercise	8–12 reps → reach 12, then add load
Leverage	Calisthenics	Incline → floor → decline
Volume	Need more stimulus	2 → 3 sets
Intensity	Strength/speed goal	More load/faster pace
Density	Conditioning	Same work with controlled rest reduction

Deload triggers

- Performance declining across several sessions
- Persistent unusual soreness
- Sleep/recovery deteriorating
- Motivation and performance both falling
- Life stress suddenly much higher

Sequencing

High-skill/high-speed work usually comes before high-fatigue work. If strength is the primary goal, strength generally comes before endurance. Concurrent-training research shows that interference is context-dependent rather than inevitable. ■cite■turn0search3■

6. Nutrition, Hydration & Body Composition

Nutrition determines whether the training stimulus can be supported.

Protein

ISSN's position stand reports 1.4–2.0 g/kg/day for most exercising people, with higher intakes sometimes useful during energy restriction in resistance-trained individuals. ■cite■turn0search14■

Practical plate

- Protein source each meal
- Carbohydrate around demanding training
- Fruit/vegetables and fiber
- Adequate dietary fat
- Fluids matched to conditions and sweat losses

Body composition

Fat loss requires a sustainable energy deficit. Muscle gain is supported by adequate training stimulus and energy. Abdominal fat cannot be selectively reduced.

Supplements

Treat supplements as optional. Evidence, dose, legality, contamination risk and individual medical context matter.

7. Recovery, Sleep & Fatigue

Recovery is not a separate topic from training; it is part of the training system.

Minimum recovery system

- Consistent sleep schedule
- Adequate food and protein
- Hydration
- Easy days
- Stress management
- Periodic deload/reassessment

Load monitoring

SIGNAL	ACTION
Normal soreness	Continue if movement is normal
Performance stable/improving	Continue progression
Several poor sessions	Review sleep, nutrition and load
Persistent pain	Stop provoking work and seek assessment
Severe symptoms	Stop and obtain medical evaluation

Health baseline

WHO recommends adults accumulate 150–300 minutes of moderate aerobic activity or 75–150 minutes vigorous activity weekly plus muscle-strengthening activity on at least two days, while recognizing that any activity is better than none. ■cite■turn0search0■turn0search4■

8. Strength Level 0–5 Curriculum

Strength is taught as a sequence of movement mastery, progressive resistance and increasingly specific performance.

Level 0 — Learn to move

PATTERN	START HERE	PASS TO LEVEL 1
Squat	Box/bodyweight squat	3×10 controlled
Hinge	Hip hinge drill	3×10 stable
Push	Wall/incline push-up	3×10 controlled
Pull	Scapular pull/inverted row	3×8 controlled
Brace	Dead bug/plank	30–45 s quality

Level 1 — Foundation

- 2–3 full-body sessions/week
- 2–3 sets/exercise
- RIR ~2–4
- Master squat, hinge, push, pull, carry and brace

Level 2 — Intermediate

- Use harder variations or external load
- 3–4 sets on major movements
- Mostly moderate repetitions
- Track progression every session

Level 3 — Strength emphasis

- Heavier compound work
- Lower repetitions on priority lifts
- Accessory work for weak links
- Longer rest for quality

Level 4 — Advanced

- Higher specificity
- Planned blocks
- Strength testing
- Individualized volume and fatigue management

Level 5 — Performance

Peak or maintain strength around another sport, using highly specific loads, velocities and testing. This stage usually benefits from individualized coaching rather than a generic template.

Advancement rule

Move up when you can complete the current level's prescribed work with repeatable technique, no pain, stable recovery and measurable progress.

9. Hypertrophy & Physique Level 0–5

Muscle development follows the same progression logic but emphasizes sufficient weekly stimulus across the muscles you want to develop.

Level 0–1

- 2–3 sessions/week
- Full-body training
- Basic push/pull/legs/core
- Learn controlled range of motion

Level 2

- Add direct shoulder/arm work
- Use 6–15-ish rep ranges as practical tools
- Build weekly volume gradually
- Keep strength movements in the program

Level 3

- Increase muscle-specific weekly volume as tolerated
- Use multiple angles for priority muscles
- Track body mass/waist/performance

Level 4

- Specialize lagging muscle groups
- Use advanced exercise selection
- Manage fatigue and exercise overlap

Level 5

Advanced physique training becomes highly individual. It can involve specialization blocks, exercise rotation and detailed nutrition. It is not simply 'more sets'.

Evidence anchor

The 2026 ACSM review found higher resistance-training volume, broadly around ≥10 sets per muscle group per week, enhanced hypertrophy, while also emphasizing progressive training. ■cite■turn0search3■

10. Advanced Strength Concepts

These concepts are optional until the simpler progression system no longer explains your progress.

Useful advanced tools

- RPE/RIR autoregulation
- Estimated 1RM
- Velocity-based training
- Block periodization
- Strength-speed / speed-strength work
- Specialization blocks
- Peaking and tapering

Do not overuse

- Constant failure training
- Unnecessary exercise complexity
- Frequent max testing
- High fatigue methods when performance is the goal

Power connection

ACSM's 2026 review reports power benefits from moderate loads moved rapidly and low-to-moderate volume. Power should be trained while fresh enough to move quickly. ■cite■turn0search3■

11. Calisthenics Level 0–5 Curriculum

Calisthenics is a long-term skill system. The curriculum separates strength prerequisites from skill practice.

Level 0 — Body control

- Dead bug
- Plank/side plank
- Scapular push-up
- Scapular pull
- Dead hang
- Controlled squat/lunge

Level 1 — Basic calisthenics

- Incline/standard push-up
- Inverted row
- Assisted chin-up
- Support hold
- Pike preparation
- Hollow hold

Level 2 — Strict strength

- Strict push-ups
- Chin-ups
- Pull-ups
- Parallel-bar dip
- Pike push-up
- Hanging knee raise

Level 3 — Weighted basics

- Weighted pull-up
- Weighted dip
- Decline/deficit push-up
- Feet-elevated pike
- Hanging leg raise
- Unilateral leg work

Level 4 — Advanced skills

- Handstand
- Muscle-up progression
- Front-lever progression
- Planche progression
- Ring strength

Level 5 — Advanced mastery

Advanced unilateral and static skills can require years. Use structured skill practice, strength maintenance and specialized coaching where joint/skill risk is high.

Advancement rule

Never advance a leverage progression merely because you can survive it. Advance when the current movement is controlled, repeatable and strong enough to support the next step.

12. Pulling, Pushing, Dips & Handstands

These are the main calisthenics pillars.

Pulling ladder

STAGE	EXERCISES	PASS INDICATOR
1	Scapular pull + rows	8–12 controlled
2	Assisted/negative pull-up	5 controlled negatives or equivalent
3	Chin-up	3–5 strict
4	Pull-up	5–10 strict
5	Weighted pull-up	Progressive loading

Pushing ladder

STAGE	EXERCISES	PASS INDICATOR
1	Incline push-up	3×10
2	Floor push-up	3×10–15
3	Decline/close-grip	3×8–12
4	Archer progression	Controlled reps
5	One-arm progression	Only with strong prerequisites

Dip ladder

- Support hold → assisted dip → negative → strict dip → weighted dip

Handstand ladder

- Wrist/shoulder preparation → wall line → wall shoulder taps → controlled kick-up → freestanding balance → advanced pressing

Shoulder rule

Pain-free shoulder/scapular control is a prerequisite. Do not force range or static holds through pain.

13. Core, Levers, Muscle-Up & Advanced Skills

Advanced skills combine strength, bodyline, timing and technique.

Core ladder

- Dead bug → plank → hollow → hanging knee raise → hanging leg raise → toes-to-bar → lever progressions

Front lever ladder

- Tuck → advanced tuck → one-leg/straddle → full, with strength-specific progression

Planche ladder

- Planche lean → tuck → advanced tuck → straddle → full, only if wrists/shoulders tolerate loading

Muscle-up pathway

- Strong strict pull-up
- Strong dip
- Explosive high pull
- Transition drills with assistance
- Band/low-bar assisted muscle-up
- Strict muscle-up

Advanced boundary

A PDF can specify progressions but cannot evaluate subtle joint positioning, speed or compensations as well as an experienced coach. Advanced static holds and ring work deserve supervision when possible.

14. Running Level 0–5 Curriculum

Running progression is governed by tolerance, aerobic development and increasing specificity.

Level 0 — Re-entry

WEEK TYPE	EXAMPLE	GOAL
Easy	1 min run / 2 min walk × 6–8	Comfortable exposure
Recovery	Walking + mobility	Low stress
Optional	Short strides only if comfortable	Coordination

Level 1 — Continuous base

- Extend run intervals
- Keep most running easy
- Build toward 15–30 min continuous

Level 2 — Aerobic development

- 2–4 runs/week
- Mostly easy
- One modestly faster session when ready

Level 3 — Threshold + intervals

- Easy volume remains dominant
- Add controlled threshold work
- Add intervals with adequate recovery

Level 4 — Performance

- Longer aerobic work
- Threshold development
- VO■/speed sessions
- Race-specific pacing

Level 5 — Advanced

Advanced runners use individualized volume, intensity distribution, strength, recovery, race-specific blocks and peaking. This is where coaching and performance testing become increasingly useful.

15. Aerobic Base, Threshold & Intervals

Each run should have a reason.

Session menu

SESSION	PURPOSE	EXAMPLE
Easy	Aerobic base/recovery	30–45 min conversational
Long easy	Durability	45–90+ min depending on level
Threshold	Sustainable hard speed	2–4 × 8 min controlled
VO■ intervals	High aerobic power	4 × 3 min hard / easy recovery
Strides	Speed mechanics	4–8 × 15–20 s relaxed fast
Hill	Strength + mechanics	6–10 × short hill with recovery

Progression rule

Increase one major variable at a time. Do not increase duration, speed and frequency together.

Intensity rule

If easy running becomes hard because of accumulated fatigue, reduce the session. More intensity is not automatically more fitness.

16. Running Mechanics, Testing & Troubleshooting

Running form should be efficient and repeatable, not cosmetically perfect.

Mechanics checklist

- Tall relaxed posture
- Quiet shoulders and arms
- Stable pelvis
- Comfortable stride
- Appropriate cadence for the individual
- Progressive exposure to speed

Tests

TEST	USE
1 km	Short performance marker
3–5 km	Aerobic performance
Continuous easy duration	Aerobic tolerance
Repeat interval pace	Speed endurance
Hill/sprint time	Acceleration/power

Troubleshooting

- Breathless early → slow down and use run/walk
- Lower-leg soreness → reduce volume/intensity and assess footwear/surface/load
- Repeated fatigue → review recovery and concurrent training
- Performance drop → deload/reassess

17. Athletic Level 0–5 Curriculum

Athletic development is a hierarchy: landing → jumping → acceleration → deceleration → change of direction → reactive speed.

Level 0

- Balance
- Marching
- Low hops
- Snap-downs
- Controlled squat/lunge

Level 1

- Pogo hops
- Squat jumps
- Broad-jump practice
- 10 m accelerations

Level 2

- Repeated jumps
- 20 m acceleration
- Deceleration drills
- Basic change of direction

Level 3

- Bounds
- Flying sprints
- Planned cuts
- Reactive drills

Level 4–5

Advanced sprint and plyometric work may use resisted sprinting, depth jumps, reactive bounds, maximal velocity work and detailed timing. These demand technical prerequisites and ideally coaching.

18. Jumping, Sprinting & Change of Direction

Power work is quality work, not conditioning disguised as jumping.

Landing criteria

- Quiet controlled landing
- Knee/hip flexion appropriate to task
- Stable trunk
- No uncontrolled collapse
- Can repeat without degradation

Sprint session

PART	EXAMPLE
Warm-up	Dynamic work + progressive accelerations
Acceleration	4–8 × 10–30 m
Recovery	Enough to preserve speed
Optional	Low-volume jumps
Cooldown	Easy movement

Change of direction

Learn braking first. The athlete should be able to lower center of mass and decelerate before adding aggressive cuts.

Evidence

Recent plyometric research supports improvements in jump, sprint and agility outcomes, but training quality and participant level vary; use evidence as guidance, not as a promise of identical results.

19. Advanced Power & Speed

Advanced power training is where individualization matters most.

Tools

- Olympic-style lifts where technically competent
- Jump squats
- Loaded jumps
- Plyometric progressions
- Resisted/assisted sprinting
- Maximal velocity exposure

Power prescription

ACSM's 2026 review identifies moderate loads (roughly 30–70% 1RM), low-to-moderate volume and fast concentric action as useful power-training features. ■cite■turn0search3■

Stop rule

When speed, height or landing quality drops meaningfully, stop the high-quality power set. Do not chase fatigue.

20. HYROX Fundamentals & Official Format

HYROX is a standardized hybrid race. The official 25/26 singles rulebook specifies eight 1 km runs and eight workout stations in a fixed sequence. ■cite■turn0search51■turn0search2■

Official sequence

ORDER	RUN → STATION
1	1 km → SkiErg 1000 m
2	1 km → Sled Push 50 m
3	1 km → Sled Pull 50 m
4	1 km → Burpee Broad Jumps 80 m
5	1 km → Row 1000 m
6	1 km → Farmer Carry 200 m
7	1 km → Sandbag Lunges 100 m
8	1 km → Wall Balls 100 reps

Rules first

Race rules, division standards and procedures can change. Use the current official HYROX rulebook for the event you enter. ■cite■turn0search2■

What to learn

- Station movement standards
- Running pacing
- Transitions
- Grip management
- Breathing under fatigue
- Division-specific loads
- Penalty rules

21. HYROX Level 0–5 Curriculum

Build HYROX capacity in layers rather than attempting a full race immediately.

Level 0

- Walk/run base
- Squat/lunge/push-up
- Carry technique
- Basic burpee movement
- General aerobic work

Level 1

- Continuous easy running
- Loaded carries
- Step-ups/lunges
- Intro ergometer technique

Level 2

- 1 km run repeats
- Moderate station combinations
- Sled technique if available
- Wall-ball technique

Level 3

- Compromised running
- Race-pace station intervals
- Transition practice
- Pacing strategy

Level 4

- Longer simulations
- Division-specific loads
- Fuel/hydration practice
- Weak-station specialization

Level 5

Advanced race preparation includes exact event standards, pacing models, transition optimization, race simulations and individualized load management.

Advancement rule

Before full simulations, you should tolerate the individual stations and repeated running without technique collapse.

22. HYROX Stations, Pacing & Race Strategy

Race performance depends on sustainable output rather than winning any single station.

Station skills

STATION	MAIN SKILLS
SkiErg	Rhythm, hinge, pull, breathing
Sled push	Leg drive, body angle, short steps
Sled pull	Bracing, rope control, repeated pulls
Burpee broad jump	Efficient floor transition + landing
Row	Stroke rhythm, legs-body-arms sequencing
Farmer carry	Grip, posture, breathing
Sandbag lunge	Balance, trunk, leg endurance
Wall balls	Squat rhythm, breathing, target accuracy

Pacing

Start below your maximum. The objective is to maintain a sustainable run pace while avoiding excessive station spikes that make the next run disproportionately difficult.

Simulation ladder

- 1 station + run
- 2–3 stations + runs
- Half-race simulation
- Full race simulation
- Race-specific taper

23. Boxing Level 0–5 Curriculum

Boxing is the discipline in this guide where self-learning has the clearest boundary: technical understanding can be taught here, but safe partner work and sparring require coaching.

Level 0 — Movement

- Stance
- Guard
- Weight distribution
- Forward/back/side steps
- Balance

Level 1 — Basic punches

- Jab
- Cross
- Lead hook
- Rear hook
- Basic uppercut
- Return to guard

Level 2 — Defense

- High guard
- Parry
- Block
- Slip
- Roll
- Step-out

Level 3 — Combinations & movement

- 1–2 combinations
- Punch + exit
- Defense + counter
- Angle creation
- Distance management

Level 4 — Applied skill

- Padwork
- Bag rounds
- Partner drills
- Controlled technical sparring under coach

Level 5 — Competitive development

Advanced tactical boxing, opponent analysis, hard sparring, competition preparation and weight management should be coach-led. England Boxing explicitly treats coaches as central to development and maintains formal coach education pathways. ■cite■turn0search12■turn0search9■

24. Stance, Footwork, Punches & Defense

Learn the pieces in a deliberate order.

Stance

- Balanced base
- Feet offset rather than crossed
- Rear heel appropriately elevated
- Hands protect while moving
- Head position controlled

Footwork ladder

LEVEL	DRILL
1	Step forward/back without crossing
2	Lateral step both directions
3	Pivot
4	Step + punch + recover
5	Angle + defense + counter
6	Opponent-reactive movement

Punch checklist

- Jab: straight path, snap back
- Cross: lower-body/torso sequencing, recover
- Hook: compact arc, stable base
- Uppercut: short path, avoid overcommitting

Defense ladder

- Guard → parry/block → slip/roll → defensive footwork → defense-to-counter

Evidence/coaching

England Boxing coaching material identifies stance, guard, footwork, punches/defences, sparring, padwork, shadowboxing, conditioning and the coach role as core parts of boxing development. ■cite■turn0search48■turn0search52■

25. Pads, Bagwork, Partner Drills & Sparring

Applied boxing requires progressively less predictable tasks.

Solo practice

TOOL	PURPOSE
Shadowboxing	Technique, movement, visualization
Heavy bag	Distance/impact/conditioning
Double-end bag	Timing/accuracy
Skipping	Rhythm/conditioning
Video	Feedback

Partner progression

- Cooperative movement drills
- Target drills
- Defense reactions
- Controlled technical rounds
- Conditioned sparring

Sparring boundary

Sparring should be supervised, matched appropriately and introduced progressively. England Boxing's 2026 rule update specifies medical requirements before first sparring in its competitive pathway. This illustrates why sparring cannot be reduced to a self-guided checklist. ■cite■turn0search5■

Session template

Warm-up → technical drill → pad/bag rounds → controlled partner drill → optional supervised sparring → cooldown/review.

26. Broader Fighting Development

“Fighting” is broader than boxing. A complete combat athlete needs striking, clinch, takedown and ground competencies.

Recommended skill domains

DOMAIN	LEARN WITH
Boxing	Qualified boxing coach
Wrestling	Wrestling coach/club
Judo	Judo coach/dojo
BJJ	BJJ coach/gym
Kickboxing/Muay Thai	Qualified striking coach
MMA	Experienced MMA coach/team

Physical preparation

- Strength
- Aerobic base
- Repeated high-intensity conditioning
- Grip/neck/trunk where appropriately coached
- Mobility and durability

Safety boundary

Do not use written instructions to practice dangerous throws, submissions, chokes, joint locks or striking against another person. Those skills require supervision, controlled equipment and partner consent.

27. Conditioning & Energy Systems

Conditioning is the ability to repeatedly perform work at the intensity your sport demands.

Session types

TYPE	EXAMPLE	ROLE
Easy aerobic	30–60 min easy	Base/recovery
Threshold	2–4 × 8–12 min	Sustainable hard effort
VO■ intervals	4 × 3 min hard	High aerobic power
Sprint	6 × 10–30 m	Speed
Circuit	Stations with controlled rest	Muscular endurance
Sport rounds	3–5 min rounds	Sport-specific repeated effort

Rule

Do not make every session hard. High-quality strength, power and technical practice depend on freshness.

28. Concurrent Training

Combining strength, endurance and sport practice is possible when priorities are explicit.

Evidence

A 2024 meta-analysis found small lower-body strength interference in males doing concurrent training, while upper-body strength and VO■max did not show the same effect. Results vary by training mode, frequency and population. ■cite■turn0search10■turn0search11■

Organization rules

- Separate hard lower-body endurance and strength when possible
- Keep easy aerobic work easy
- Put the priority quality first
- Use one or two true high-stress days rather than making all days hard
- Protect sleep and nutrition

Example

DAY	GENERAL ATHLETE
Mon	Upper strength + calisthenics
Tue	Run + lower strength
Wed	Easy aerobic + mobility
Thu	Power + upper hypertrophy
Fri	Lower strength + conditioning
Sat	Technical sport / easy activity
Sun	Rest

Adjustment rule

If one sport becomes the priority, reduce secondary volume before adding more total training.

29. Choosing Priorities & Building a Week

One person cannot simultaneously maximize every physical quality. The solution is priority management.

Priority model

PRIORITY	MAIN	SECONDARY
Strength/muscle	3–5 resistance sessions	2–3 easy aerobic + low-volume power
Running	3–5 runs	2 strength + mobility
Calisthenics	3–5 skill/strength exposures	2 lower-body + aerobic
HYROX	2–4 runs + 1–2 station sessions	2 strength
Boxing	2–4 coached boxing sessions	2 strength + aerobic
Power	2–3 speed/power sessions	2 strength + low aerobic

Decision rule

Choose one primary performance outcome for each 8–12 week block. Maintain other qualities with the minimum effective dose.

Beginner rule

Beginners should resist the urge to run every roadmap simultaneously. General preparation first; specialization later.

30. 12-Month Master Roadmap

This roadmap provides a default general-athlete curriculum; individual sport goals should modify it.

Months 1–3 — Foundation

- Movement quality
- Run/walk base
- Basic strength
- Strict calisthenics patterns
- Landing fundamentals
- Intro technical boxing if desired

Months 4–6 — Capacity

- More resistance volume
- Continuous running
- Pull-up/dip progression
- Low-level power
- HYROX station foundations
- Boxing combinations

Months 7–9 — Development

- Higher strength and hypertrophy
- Threshold/interval running
- Progressive plyometrics
- Compromised running
- Applied boxing drills

Months 10–12 — Integration

- Testing
- Sport-specific blocks
- Race/skill simulations
- Maintain strength
- Deload and reassess

Year 2+

Move toward specialization: advanced calisthenics, running performance, HYROX competition, boxing competition, strength/physique or power/speed.

31. Advancement Tests & Scorecards

Use objective criteria rather than feelings to decide when to progress.

General scorecard

QUALITY	FOUNDATION INDICATOR	ADVANCED INDICATOR
Strength	Clean reps at current load	High-specificity strength test
Calisthenics	Strict basics	Weighted/skill milestones
Running	30 min easy continuous	Race/threshold performance
Power	Controlled broad jump	Timed sprint/jump testing
HYROX	Station technique	Race-specific simulation
Boxing	Coach-approved fundamentals	Coach-rated applied skill

Pass rules

- Technique stable
- No pain or warning symptoms
- Recovery adequate
- Performance repeatable
- Current workload no longer challenging enough

Testing schedule

Baseline, 8–12 weeks, 6 months and 12 months are useful general checkpoints. Test fewer things but test them consistently.

32. Troubleshooting

Use the symptom to identify the likely programming problem.

Problem → response

PROBLEM	FIRST CHECK
Not getting stronger	Technique, effort, progression, sleep, calories
Not gaining muscle	Weekly volume, protein, energy, exercise selection
Running always feels hard	Pace, recovery, too much intensity
Calisthenics stuck	Prerequisite strength, leverage, skill frequency
Jumps/sprints slow	Fatigue, too much volume, insufficient rest
HYROX collapse late	Pacing, station efficiency, aerobic base
Boxing feels chaotic	Stance, footwork, distance, coached drills
Constant soreness	Volume/frequency/recovery

The 80% rule

Fix simple variables before adding advanced methods. Better sleep, better pacing, cleaner technique and consistent progression often solve problems that appear to require complex programming.

33. Logs, Checklists & Glossary

Use the following pages as reusable templates.

Daily log

FIELD	WRITE
Date	
Session	
Exercises / rounds	
Load / reps / time	
RPE or RIR	
Sleep	
Pain/symptoms	
One improvement	
Next-session adjustment	

Weekly review

- What improved?
- What stalled?
- What felt too hard?
- What recovery problem appeared?
- What is the next week's single priority?

Glossary

TERM	MEANING
1RM	One-repetition maximum
RIR	Repetitions in reserve
RPE	Rating of perceived exertion
Hypertrophy	Increase in muscle size
VO■max	Maximum oxygen uptake rate
Threshold	Hard sustainable intensity boundary
Plyometric	Explosive stretch-shortening training
Concurrent training	Strength + endurance in the same program
Deload	Reduction in training stress
Relative strength	Strength relative to body mass
Compromised running	Running after a fatiguing station

Weekly checklist

- Did I complete the priority sessions?
- Did I progress or consolidate?
- Did I recover?
- Did I record the data?
- Do I need to hold, progress or deload?

34. Evidence & References

This curriculum uses current public guidance and research as anchors. Sport rules should always be checked against the governing body's current documents.

Core sources

- WHO physical-activity recommendations for adults: 150–300 min moderate or 75–150 min vigorous aerobic activity plus major-muscle strengthening on ≥2 days/week. ■cite■turn0search0■turn0search4■
- ACSM 2026 Position Stand: Resistance Training Prescription for Muscle Function, Hypertrophy, and Physical Performance in Healthy Adults; PMID 41843416. ■cite■turn0search3■
- HYROX official rulebooks; 25/26 Singles rulebook specifies eight 1 km runs and eight stations. ■cite■turn0search51■turn0search2■
- England Boxing Coaching Handbook, 2026: fundamental movement, stance, guard, footwork, punches/defences, sparring, padwork, shadowboxing, conditioning and coaching. ■cite■turn0search48■
- England Boxing 2026 rule updates and coaching resources. ■cite■turn0search5■turn0search9■
- ISSN Position Stand: protein and exercise. ■cite■turn0search14■
- Concurrent-training meta-analysis, Sports Medicine, 2024. ■cite■turn0search10■turn0search11■

Final answer to the reader

This curriculum is designed so a motivated person can understand what to learn, what to practice, how to progress and when to advance from beginner toward advanced levels. However, 'advanced' does not mean safely self-taught in every domain. Boxing/fighting sparring, complex Olympic lifting, maximal sprinting, high-level gymnastics-style skills and rehabilitation require appropriate coaching or professional supervision.

The operating principle

Learn → practice → log → recover → test → progress → specialize. Do not skip prerequisites. Do not turn every sport into a maximum-effort workout. Build the athlete first; then build the specialist.